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TAB 15



Board of Education Report

File #: Rep-112-23/24, **Version:** 1

Approval of the Closure of Hilda Solis Learning Academy and the Relocation and Expansion of Boyle Heights STEM Magnet High School

March 12, 2024

Office of the Chief Strategy Officer

Action Proposed:

Authorize the following actions:

- The closure of the Hilda L. Solis Learning Academy (Solis) and associated County-District-School (CDS) code effective July 1, 2024.
- The relocation of Boyle Heights STEM Magnet High School (Boyle Heights STEM) to the Hilda Solis school site (with existing CDS code and temporary name of Boyle Heights Hilda Solis High School) commencing with the 2024-25 school year.

Background:

The Solis school site is located in East Los Angeles and the school participates in the Eastside Zone of Choice to attract enrollment. Solis's 2023 Norm Day enrollment is 169 students, and Boyle Heights STEM's 2023 Norm Day enrollment is 135 students. Both schools have experienced declining enrollment in the last six years.

Boyle Heights STEM has been co-located on the campus of Hollenbeck Middle School since July 2019, when it was temporarily moved from the adjacent Roosevelt High School to accommodate the construction of a large scale, multi-year comprehensive modernization project. Boyle Heights STEM offers unique programming, including the award-winning robotics program and Gold Certified Linked Learning college and career readiness pathway. The Solis site opened in 2012 in the former East LA Star Hospital and consists of newer facilities including 24 standard classrooms, one small classroom, and support facilities, including a gymnasium. The facility has ample space to house and expand the STEM program. The site also includes separate facilities for the East LA Occupational Center.

Extensive stakeholder engagement has occurred, including three rounds of meetings with staff, students and families led by Region East and the Strategic Enrollment and Program Planning Office in April, May, September, and November of 2023, and on February 15, 2024. Through these meetings, feedback was solicited on what school staff, students and families desired in a learning environment and the opportunities the relocation and expansion of Boyle Heights STEM could provide to the Solis Learning Academy community. Feedback from these groups has also informed the planned implementation of this relocation and expansion, including offering bus transportation, and continuing the magnet program. In December 2023, the principal for Boyle Heights STEM also held an articulation meeting with the Solis staff to share details regarding the STEM program. Labor partners have been engaged and offered the opportunity to discuss and bargain effects of this proposed action.

Expected Outcomes:

Approval of the proposed action will close the Solis school, and its students will be offered access to Boyle Heights STEM's Gold Certified Linked Learning pathway and award-winning robotics program. In addition, Boyle Heights STEM students will now be located at a site designated for high school programs.

Board Options and Consequences:

A "YES" vote approves the closure of Hilda Solis Learning Academy and the relocation and expansion of Boyle Heights STEM Magnet.

A "NO" vote would result in no changes to Hilda Solis L. Learning Academy and the Boyle Heights STEM Magnet, which impacts the District's ability to provide equitable access to comprehensive A-G programs at both schools.

Policy Implications:

This action does not change District policy.

Budget impact:

Up to \$300,000 has been preliminarily estimated to support the relocation of Boyle Heights STEM from Hollenbeck Middle School to the Solis site. If potential facilities improvements are requested and/or needed, the Office of the Chief Strategy Officer will need to identify additional funding sources, and work with the Facilities Services Division to scope the project.

Student Impact:

The proposed action will enhance the educational experience of students enrolled in Solis and Boyle Heights STEM, and also offer a unique educational program for the East Los Angeles area community. The proximity to East Los Angeles College increases opportunities for students to take advantage of dual enrollment classes and advanced courses.

Equity Impact:

All students deserve to have access to high-quality, sustainable educational programs. By relocating the existing Boyle Heights STEM program into its own facilities and increasing enrollment, the school will have additional staff and resources, enabling it to offer a more robust high school program for students.

Issues and Analysis:

No students will be displaced by this action. The Boyle Heights STEM Magnet High School will be relocated from Hollenbeck Middle School to the current campus of Hilda L. Solis Learning Academy. Boyle Heights STEM Magnet High School will be temporarily renamed Boyle Heights Hilda Solis High School. The current Hilda Solis Learning Academy will be merged with the temporarily renamed Boyle Heights Hilda Solis High School. This action will expand an award-winning STEM program at a site where facilities are not shared with other K-12 schools. Existing Solis students will receive priority to be part of the school. Transportation to the Hilda Solis campus will be provided from Hollenbeck Middle School to any Boyle Heights STEM student through Transportation Opportunities for Students (TOPS). In the Fall 2024, the new school community will follow the District's formal process to rename the school.

Attachments:

Not Applicable.

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Informative:
Not applicable.

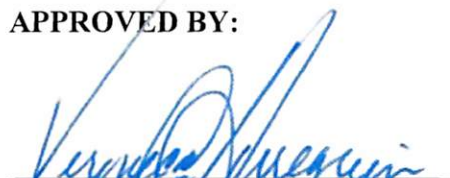
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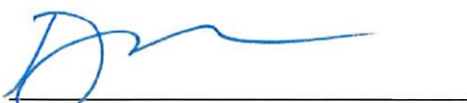
RESPECTFULLY SUBMITTED,


ALBERTO M. CARVALHO
Superintendent

APPROVED BY:


VERONICA ARREGUIN
Chief Strategy Officer
Office of the Chief Strategy Officer

REVIEWED BY:


DEVORA NAVERA REED
General Counsel

APPROVED & PRESENTED BY:


DERRICK CHAU
Senior Executive Director
Strategy & Innovation
Office of the Chief Strategy Officer

☒ Approved as to form.

REVIEWED BY:


NOLBERTO DELGADILLO
Deputy Chief Business Officer, Finance

☒ Approved as to budget impact statement.